

PDP legislator Muzaffar Hussain Baig implicating Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah in a sex scandal was akin to a schoolboy throwing tantrums. Abdullah, on his part, should have been more mature and should have had the imagination to see through the PDP's bluff.
K.R. VENKATA NARASIMHAN,
Bangalore

Wilting Lotus

The BJP has been beset with internal wrangles and intolerance towards leaders with a different point of view in the Parliament session ("The War Within", August 10). They should do well to find ways to stand together and remain a constructive opposition. Any split at this juncture will prove suicidal considering that the Jaitley-Rajnath spat has already done much damage to the party.
K.S. THAMPI, Vijayanagar

A great national party like the BJP has certainly lost its direction. Sushma Swaraj, a potential successor of Lal Krishna Advani, attributes the party's defeat in the recent Lok Sabha elections to "circumstances". I think these circumstances were self-inflicted. Unless the party jettisons its Hindutva philosophy, stops projecting Narendra Modi as a future leader

and election winner and denies election tickets to candidates like Varun Gandhi, it would become a 'party of yesterday'.
M. RIAZ HASAN,
Hyderabad

Judgement Error

Prime Minister Manmohan Singh has committed a blunder by signing a joint statement of peace wherein there is a reference to Balochistan ("The Summit Jinx", Aug-

MANDAR DEODHAR



Terrorism can't be tackled unless the security forces are fully equipped. Total integration between all the agencies is the basic prerequisite to prevent another 26/11.

V.K. TANGRI, Dehradun

ust 10). Also, it is sad that Congress President Sonia Gandhi is also supporting Singh on this issue. Finally, the gates have been opened for Pakistan to make unnecessary allegations against India over the Balochistan problem.
MAHESH KUMAR,
via www.indiatoday.in

Blast from the Past

It is surprising that the appointments of university vice-chancellors are being questioned now instead of when these were made ("Dubious Distinction", August 10). Moreover, former Uttar Pradesh governor T.V. Rajeshwar cannot be blamed unless such appointments were made overlooking the recommendations of the committee that takes the

final call on such appointments. Secondly, the accusation of saving Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Mayawati despite being a Congress appointee only shows that Rajeshwar did not act at the behest of the Centre.
S.N. SHUKLA,
Lucknow

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

OCTOBER 1-15, 1979

Election Huddle

The election machinery has moved into top gear to prepare for the biggest general election in the world—but the poll campaigns are yet to take off. A unique feature of the coming parliamentary poll is that it is likely to be fought on the lines of a presidential election with the main contenders selling prime ministers rather than their parties. Unlike past elections, each of the parties has an aspiring prime minister to project as the miracle worker to solve the nation's problems. In this epidemic of the personality cult, the Congress (I) has its perennial leader, Indira Gandhi. The Janata (S)—which has adopted the new name of Lok Dal—and its allies are offering the services of caretaker prime minister Charan Singh and the Janata Party is projecting the redoubtable Jagjivan Ram as its candidate.

by Arul B. Louis



INDIRA
GANDHI

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

E-MAIL YOUR LETTERS TO: letters.editor@intoday.com

FAX THEM TO: 011-23316180

OR LOG ON TO: www.indiatoday.in